page draft on economic policy became the starting point of yet another major internal party debate.[90]

As internal BJP tussles on economics played out in public, Congress leader Mani Shankar Aiyar argued that the 'BJP, having run out of steam on Ayodhya, and having its forward gear put into reverse by the Joshi yatra, now finds itself so caught up in internal contradictions over economic policies that it is unable to evolve the "third model" of development it had promised its cadres.'[91] As an RSS leader told a newspaper, in some ways, it was like a 'spider caught in its own web'.[92] The party was going into parliamentary debates without its right hand knowing what its left hand was doing. The internal turmoil was so public that Aiyar even published a tongue-in-cheek economic vision document for his political rival.[93]

So intense was this internal warfare that the industrialist Rahul Bajaj, in 1998, publicly articulated how confusing the BJP's positioning appeared to some. 'I don't think the BJP is very clear what their policy would be,' he said. 'People in the party are speaking with different voices.' All wings of the party united against the WTO's ask that tariff barriers come down, and against unhindered capital flows and investments like that of Coca-Cola, which they said they would not allow. As Shettigar declared, 'India is not there to protect the interest of foreign investors, whether FDI [foreign direct investment] or FII [foreign institutional investment]. We are supposed to protect our own interest.'[94]

RSS ideologue S. Gurumurthy's views on foreign capital at the time are instructive. In 1998, he pointed to the South-East Asian economies as a model for India to emulate, telling a news magazine that India should not allow any 'controlling equity' to foreign companies. As he put it, 'Japan and Korea do not permit controlling equity. FDI in the consumer sector, including automobiles, must go. However, the methods can be worked out without prejudice to our economic interest. During the nationalisation spree of the '70s, Unilever was permitted to hold more shares. Something on that line can be worked out. And no FDI in food sector. Because it infringes on our culture. Coca-Cola is not a drink but a sign of American machismo. The variety of Indian cuisine should not be supplanted by